

ROHIT GUPTA



on to them, and when to sell. If your approach to investment is haphazard—buying a stock here, a fund there, selling every time the market drops—you're unlikely to meet your investment goals. In fact, you're more likely to lose money than see your portfolio grow.

Using the map you create for yourself, you will begin to get more familiar with different types of investments, such as stocks, funds, and cash equivalents. And, like Bangalore-based Satnam Singh Gandhi, you will realise the worth of tracking your investments diligently. Gandhi takes stock of his portfolio on a weekly basis, and gets most of his information from television, newspapers, websites and reports from his brokerage. The result? His portfolio has grown five-fold in one year.

RAKESH GOYAL, 47

Delhi

INVESTING IN STOCKS SINCE 1980

INITIAL INVESTMENT Rs 20,000

CURRENT PORTFOLIO VALUE Rs 2 lakh

WHAT I DO WHEN THE MARKET FALLS I have learnt to live with volatility.

WHAT I LEARNT After 1992 scam, I stayed away from equities for almost five years. I re-entered with better understanding and have been booking profits.

I entered the market at a young age. The biggest lesson I have learnt is to invest for the long term.

3 RESEARCH BEFORE YOU INVEST

To invest in the stock market intelligently, you must do your homework first. Sardar Balvinder Singh, an investor from Ludhiana who has made hefty profits in the stock market, says he has learnt to "chase shares, analyse and study them thoroughly, and invest for the long term". The good news is that there's more than sufficient information freely available—on websites, newspapers, magazines and brokerage reports. All it takes is a little patience to read them. Investing without researching is pretty much like going to a roulette table and betting all your money on red. Research helps to reduce the element of chance.

There are some investors like Srinivas Chittaluru of Hyderabad,